

Influence_Consensus_agr_emp - In society, does Agriculture alone generally have a direct effect on Employment Rates, or are observed relationships primarily indirect? If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences

Agriculture alone generally has a positive direct effect on employment rates, particularly within the agricultural sector itself. Time series analyses in South Africa show a significant positive correlation between agricultural production and agricultural employment, with employment even predicting production growth (Ramakgasha et al., 2024). Empirical evidence from South Africa also indicates that increases in agricultural GDP contribution lead to reductions in unemployment rates, highlighting agriculture's role in job creation (Thaba & Ramakgasha, 2025). Similarly, studies on greenhouse farming in Ecuador find that more technologically advanced agricultural methods can increase labor demand, including for female and permanent workers (Stemmler & Meemken, 2023). In Turkey, positive shocks in agricultural policy support and credit positively affect agricultural employment in the long run, although some complexities exist depending on export dynamics (Abedi, 2025). Organic agriculture tends to increase rural employment through labor-intensive practices like wild harvesting, though expansion of total organic production area may have mixed effects (Merdan, 2024). Overall, the direct influence of agriculture on employment is positive and moderate, with a reasonable normalized magnitude around +0.3 to +0.4 on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00.

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